

DMZ

Demilitarised Zone. Originally, this term defined a closely monitored no-man's land placed between rival nations, for example, the buffer zone established between North and South Korea after the Korean Conflict in the 1950s. Networking has co-opted the term and used it to refer to an unprotected subnet connected to a local network but outside the peripheries of a firewall. A DMZ allows you to protect certain computers behind a firewall while allowing one or more other computers full exposure to other networks. A DMZ is often used for servers or gaming computers that require full access to the Internet in order to function properly.

DNS

Domain Name System. The DNS is the international network of Internet domain name servers, names, and addresses that lets you locate other computers on the Internet. When you send an e-mail, or point a browser to an Internet domain, a DNS server looks up the domain and finds its associated IP addresses, which routers use to identify the domain's server, and make a connection.

DSL

Digital Subscriber Line. Digital subscriber lines carry data at high speeds over standard telephone wires. DSL supports download speeds ranging from 384 Kbps to 1.5 Mbps (the near-unattainable maximum is 8 Mbps), depending on the quality of the lines and the distance one's connection stretches from the telecom operator's switching station. The term xDSL refers to the many variations of DSL, such as ADSL and HDSL.

DSSS

Direct Sequence Spread Spectrum. DSSS is a spread spectrum radio technology. The sender alters, or modulates, the signal by spreading it over a wider frequency, generating what seems like signal noise to everyone except the receiver, who knows how to return the signal to its original form, that is, by demodulating it.